30-DAY GIT LEARNING SERIES

GIT QUEST

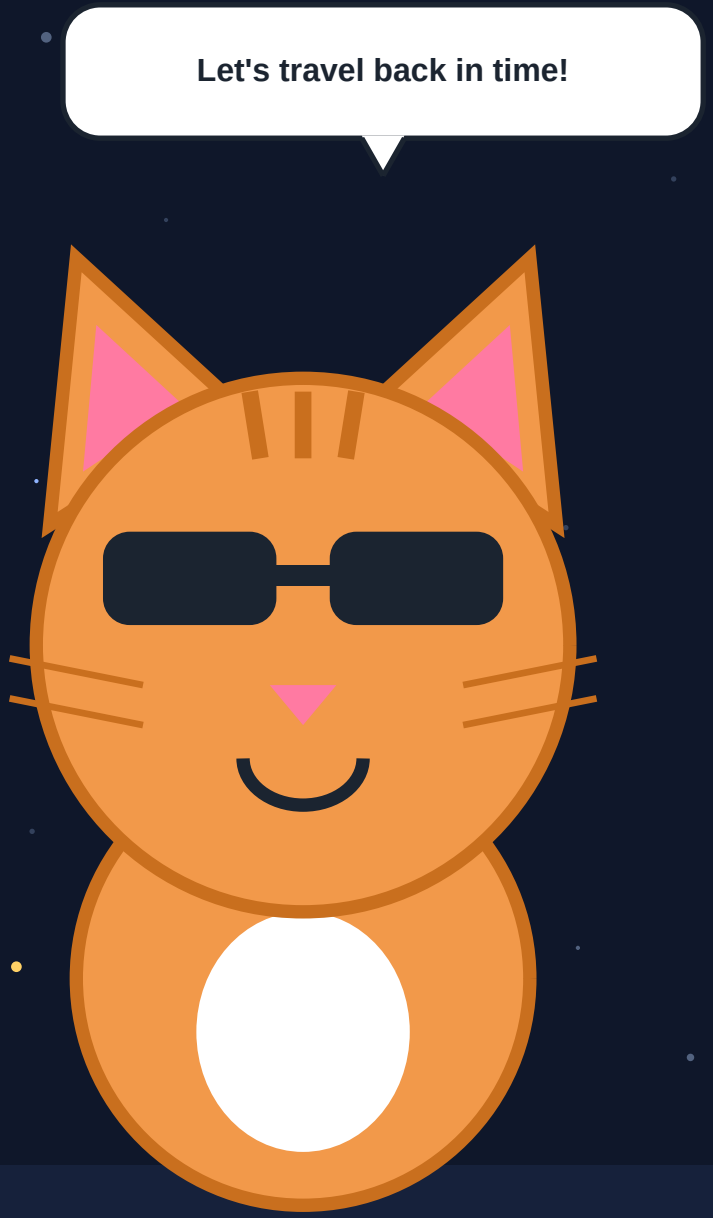
LEVEL 5

git log: Your Time Machine

Week 1: First Steps | Absolute Beginner

QUEST PROGRESS: DAY 5 OF 30

Created by Rutuja Naik



The Story: Back to the Past

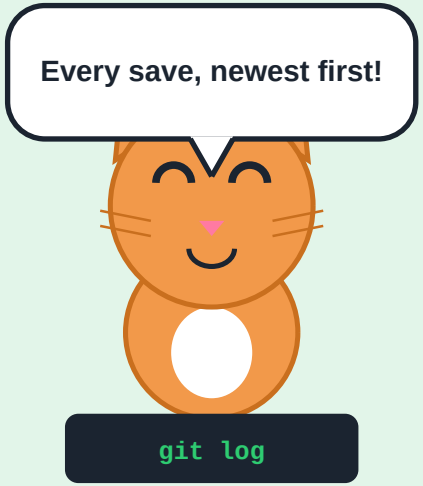
Commit the Cat wants to know what happened last week.

1

The question

Without a history, you can only guess. With Git, every save point is remembered.

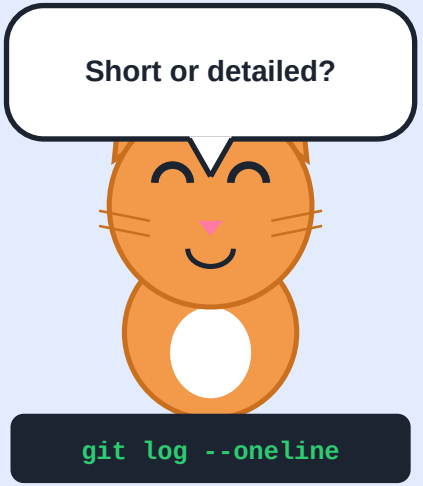
2



git log

Lists all your commits with ID, author, date and message.

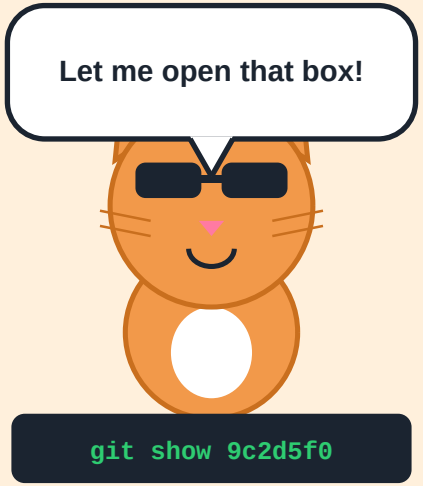
3



Zoom levels

Add --oneline for a tidy list, or --stat to see which files changed.

4



git show

Opens a single commit so you can see exactly what it changed.

Reading git log

One entry, decoded. Then five zoom levels.

```
commit e41b7a9c3d1f2a8b6e0c5d4f7a9b1c... (HEAD -> main)
Author: Rutuja Naik <you@example.com>
Date:   Mon Nov 9 10:42:17 2026 +0530

    Add travel plans
```

1. **e41b7a9**
   The commit's unique ID (hash). 7 characters are enough.
2. **HEAD -> main**
   You are here: the commit you are on.
3. **Author and Date**
   Who saved it, and when.
4. **Message**
   The label you wrote on Day 4.

FIVE ZOOM LEVELS OF git log

1	`git log`	Everything: ID, author, date, message
2	`git log --oneline`	One tidy line per commit
3	`git log --oneline -n 3`	Only the last 3 commits
4	`git log --stat`	Which files each commit touched
5	`git log --graph --oneline`	History drawn as a map (shines with branches)

Stuck on a screen with (END)? Press q to quit!

Quest Board: Build and Explore

Finish 4 quests, then collect 3 commits as loot.

1 Make a time-travel repo

```
$ git init -b main time-machine
$ cd time-machine
```

2 Make 4 commits (repeat the pattern)

```
$ echo "Went to the market" > diary.txt
$ git add diary.txt
$ git commit -m "Add first diary entry"
$ echo "Learned Git today" >> diary.txt
```

Then add + commit it. Do 2 more (3rd entry, then plans.txt).

3 Travel back in time

```
$ git log
$ git log --oneline
```

Press q to leave the log screen.

4 Zoom in on one commit

```
$ git log --stat -2
$ git show HEAD
```

LOOT: TODAY'S 3 COMMITS

COMMIT 1

day05-git-log/lesson.md

```
docs(day05): add lesson on git log time machine
```

The lesson: zoom levels and git show.

COMMIT 2

day05-git-log/demo.tape

```
feat(day05): add VHS tape for git log demo
```

Script that records the terminal GIF.

COMMIT 3

exercise.md + days-1-to-5-summary.md

```
docs(day05): add exercise and days 1-5 summary
```

Challenge, plus a recap of Days 1 to 5.

Tip: the 7-character ID from git log --oneline is all you need for git show.

Boss Fight and Bonus Loot

Cheat sheet, shortcuts, escape tricks and your next unlock.

BONUS 1: DAY 5 CHEAT SHEET

```
git log                    Full history
git log --oneline          One line per commit
git log --oneline -n 3     Last 3 commits only
git log --stat             Files each commit touched
git log --graph --oneline  Draw the map
git log --grep="diary"     Search messages
git show <hash>            Open one commit
```

BONUS 2: MAKE YOUR OWN SHORTCUT

```
git config --global alias.lg "log --oneline --graph --decorate"
git lg      <- your new shortcut!
```

BONUS 3: ESCAPING THE LOG SCREEN

```
q         quit the log screen
space     next page
arrows    scroll up and down
```

BOSS FIGHT: QUICK QUIZ

1. Which command shows one line per commit?
2. What does HEAD mean?
3. How do you leave the log screen when it opens?

Answers: 1) git log --oneline 2) The commit you are on: 'you are here' 3) Press q

CHALLENGE

Use git log --stat to find the commit that added plans.txt, then open it with git show and its 7-character ID.

LEVEL 6: git diff, spot the difference

Unlocks tomorrow. See exactly which lines changed between two versions.

LOCKED